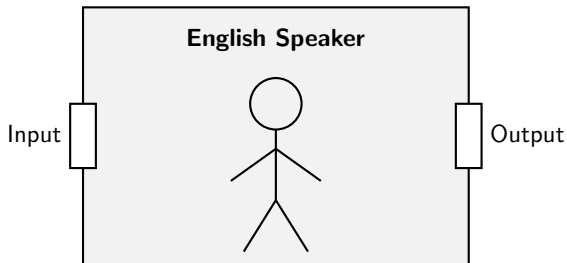


The Chinese Room Argument

A Visual Perspective

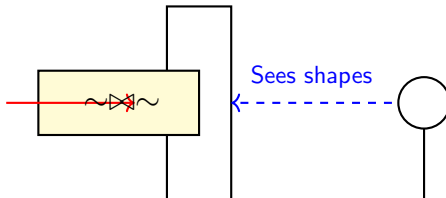
Philosophy of Mind

1. The Closed Room



- Imagine a closed room with no windows.
- The person inside knows exactly **zero** Chinese.

2. The Mysterious Input



- A piece of paper slides through the "Input" slot.
- To the person: Meaningless shapes.
- To outsiders: A Chinese character question.

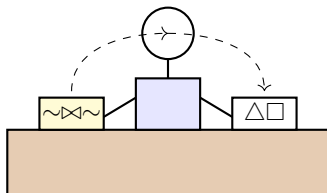
3. The Giant Rulebook

English Rulebook

If: $\sim \bowtie \sim$	Write: $\triangle \square$
If: Ω^*	Write: $\nabla \circ$

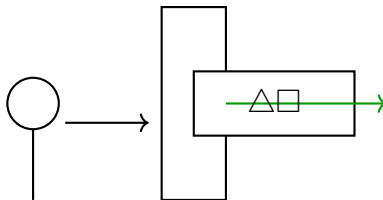
- The person has a massive, English-written rulebook.
- It doesn't translate; it is a purely visual matching game.

4. The Mechanical Process



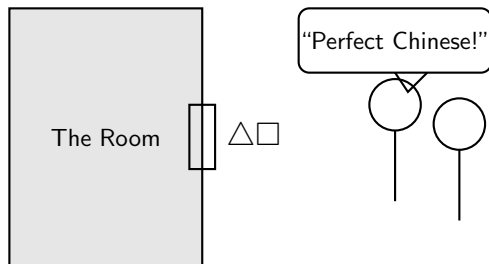
- The person finds the exact matching shapes in the rulebook.
- They carefully draw the corresponding output shapes.

5. The Output



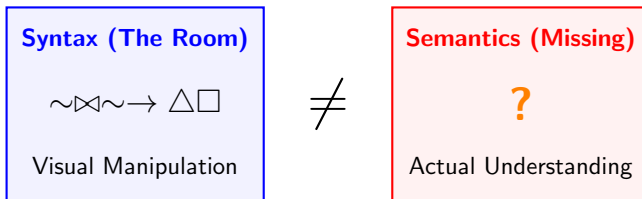
- The newly drawn symbols are pushed through the "Output" slot.
- The person inside has **no idea** what they just wrote.

6. The Illusion of Fluency



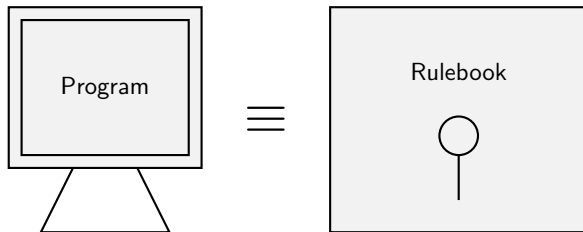
- Native speakers outside read a logically perfect answer.
- They visually perceive that there is a "Chinese speaker" inside.

7. Syntax vs. Semantics



- **Syntax:** Recognizing and moving shapes (what the person did).
- **Semantics:** Understanding meaning (what the person lacked).

8. Conclusion: Strong AI is False



- If a human acting as a program doesn't understand Chinese...
- ...then a computer running that same program doesn't either.